



**LAGOS STATE MINISTRY OF
COMMERCE, COOPERATIVES,
TRADE & INVESTMENT**

LAGOS STATE GOVERNMENT

MINISTRY OF COMMERCE COOPERATIVES TRADE AND INVESTMENT

GUIDELINE ON REGISTRATION OF COOPERATIVES IN LAGOS

In accordance with the provisions of Lagos State Cooperative Societies Laws 2022 as amended, all intending Cooperative Societies are required or mandated to register with the Directorate of Cooperative Services under the Lagos State Ministry of Commerce, Cooperatives, Trade and Investment (MCCTI).

PROCEDURES:

Steps for Cooperative Registration

1. Submission of written application for registration to the office of the Permanent Secretary, Ministry of Commerce, Cooperatives, Trade and Investment.
2. Holding of Inaugural Meeting.
3. Payment of applicable registration fees
4. Trustees (President, Secretary and Treasurer) of the Cooperative Society to attend induction course at the Lagos State Cooperative College.
5. Purchase of the statutory books for record keeping.
6. Monitoring and supervision for three (3) months
7. Issuance of Certificate of Registration and Bye-laws.

Consequently, the below table is the sequence that spelt out the step by step procedures and timelines;

S/N	PROCEDURES	WHERE TO CONTACT	TIMELINE	REMARK
1	Enquiry about Cooperative Society's registration modality at MCCTI or Cooperative Area Offices closest to the location address of intending Cooperative Society. At this point requirement list will be given to the intending Cooperative Society.	Ministry/ Cooperative Area Offices close to the address of the proposed Cooperative Society	A day	When Satisfied, the promoter of this registration shall return back to the intending Cooperative Society for a feedback and to decide on the next point of action.



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2	Submission of application letter (LETTER OF INTENT) to the office of the Permanent Secretary (MCCTI), Block 8, The Secretariat, Alausa, Ikeja or Cooperative Area Offices. See the below list and contact lines in the attached table II.	Ministry/ Cooperative Area Offices	A day	The letter signifies the intention of the proposed Cooperative Society to be recognized as a legal entity through registration. The letter shall notify the Ministry of its intention and also extending invitation to the Ministry for the Inaugural Meeting of the Cooperative Society.
				This inauguration meeting shall be attended by Registrars/Cooperative Officers from the specific Cooperative Area Office where the application is submitted.
3	Issuance of acknowledgement letter from the Ministry indicating acceptance or rejection of letter of Intent via email, telephone call, or hard copy.	Ministry through the respective Cooperative Area Office	A day	On receipt of the letter of intent, a name search will be carried out to eliminate duplication of names.
4	Purchase of the statutory books for record keeping.	Lagos State Cooperative Federation (LASCOFED)	A day	The operational purpose of the statutory books will be explained at the inaugural meeting.



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5	Holding of Inaugural Meeting by the intending Cooperative Society with the Ministry officials (Registrars of Cooperative or Cooperative Officers) in attendance.	Designated registered address of the proposed Cooperative Society	A day	The Cooperative Society with a minimum of twenty (20) members that are above 18 years of age in attendance, with a common bond among them will be enlightened/briefed on how registered Cooperative Societies operate in Lagos State as contained in reviewed Lagos State Cooperative Societies Laws, 2022, Model bye-laws, and Operational Guidelines from the office of the Director (Cooperative Services). This will serve as verification exercise on the proposed Cooperative Society
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6	Hosting of an independent general Meeting.	Designated registered address of the proposed Cooperative Society	A month after the inaugural meeting	This meeting will avail the intending members the opportunity to ponder on what was discussed with them by the Ministry's official(s), and the following will be resolve on: i. whether to continue the registration process ii. the name of the Cooperative Society. iii. how to raise funds to kick start the process. iv. when to make payment for the induction course at the Cooperative College of proposed Cooperative Society's trustee members.
7	Collection of application form for the registration of a Cooperative Society {Form S1} (No fee payment).	Ministry through the respective Cooperative Area Office	A day	Filling of registration form by the Management Committee
8	Payment of registration fee viz a viz the type of Cooperative Society;	Payment is made to designated bank account by the Cooperative Society	At the discretion of the proposed Cooperative Society	See the table below for schedule of fees.



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9	Submission of completed registration form to the Directorate of Cooperative Service for further actions with the following: ❖ Evidence of payments ❖ Verification of information submitted by the Cooperative	Ministry through the respective Cooperative Area Office	A day	
	Society on the registration form (Form S1) ❖ All reports as submitted by the Cooperative Area Office(s).			
10	Issuance & Collection of Certificate of Registration to the Cooperative Society.	Ministry through the respective Cooperative Area Office	A day	This is based on the recommendation of the registration officer to the Office of the Director of Cooperative Services. Upon approval, the Cooperative Society will be issued a registered Certificate in its verified name, two (2) sealed and signed Bye-laws, and two (2) copies of registration form S1.

Note: The duration for registering of Cooperative Societies shall take an average of three (3) months. The reason for this, is to allow the group of persons to understudy themselves and be assured of their compatibility to operate as a Cooperative Society.



REQUIREMENTS

Members must satisfy the under-listed requirements before picking up registration forms:

1. Members must be 18 years old and above.
2. The proposed Cooperative Society must consist of persons with good character and sound mind.
3. Members must share a common bond (e.g staff of the same company or people engaged in similar trade or business).
4. Foundation members must be at least 20 (twenty) persons.
5. Hosting of inaugural meeting by the proposed Cooperative Society
6. Hosting of an independent general meeting.
7. Induction Training of trustees (President, General Secretary, & Treasurer) at the Lagos State Cooperative College for exposure to practical skills of running a Cooperative Society.
8. Collection of application forms for registration of a Cooperative Society.

SCHEDULE OF FEE:

Registration fee payable from January, 2023 is as follows:

S/N	TYPE OF COOPERATIVE SOCIETY	AMOUNT (#)	LASG'S REVENUE CODE	TIMELINE FOR ISSUANCE REGISTRATIONS CERTIFICATE.
1	Cooperative Multipurpose Society (CMS)	30,000.	Bank: Polaris Bank Account name: Lagos State Government Account number: 4030010449 Pay ID:C.36858 Min's Code: 04004/4270000 Revenue Code: 4020039	One month



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2	Cooperative Thrift and Credit Society (CTCS)	20,000	Bank: Polaris Bank Account name: Lagos State Government Account number: 4030010449 Pay ID:C.36858 Min's Code: 04004/4270000 Revenue Code: 4020039	One month
3	Cooperative Agriculture Multipurpose Society (CAMS)	20,000	Bank: Polaris Bank Account name: Lagos State Government Account number: 4030010449 Pay ID:C.36858 Min's Code: 04004/4270000 Revenue Code: 4020039	One month

For further information please contact

Department of Cooperatives,
Ministry of Commerce, Cooperatives, Trade & Investment
Block 8, The Secretariat,
Alausa, Ikeja.

Phone number: 08033806316

Signed
Permanent Secretary
Ministry of Commerce, Cooperatives, Trade & Investment